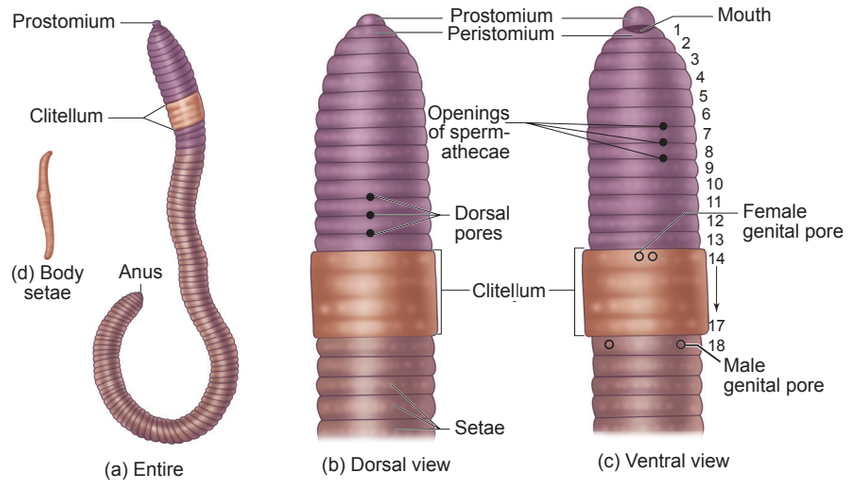


Figure 4.2 *Lampito mauritii*

surface moist and free from harmful microorganisms. Spermathecal openings are three pairs of small ventrolateral apertures lying intersegmentally between the grooves of the segments 6/7, 7/8 and 8/9. A pair of female genital apertures lie on the ventral side in the 14th segment and a pair of male genital apertures are situated latero-ventrally in the 18th segment. Nephridiopores are numerous and found throughout the body of the earthworm except a few anterior segments, through which the metabolic wastes are eliminated.

Table 4.1: Morphological and anatomical differences between *Lampito mauritii* and *Metaphire posthuma*

S.No	Characters	*Lampito mauritii*	*Metaphire posthuma*
1.	**Shape and size**	Cylindrical 80 mm – 210 mm in length 3.5mm - 5.0 mm in width	Cylindrical 115 – 130 mm in length 5 mm in width
2.	**Colouration**	Light Brown	Dark Brown
3.	**Segmentation**	165 – 190 Segments	About 140 Segments
4.	**Clitellum**	14th – 17th Segments (4)	14th – 16th Segments (3)
5.	**Spermathecal opening**	Three pairs 6/7, 7/8 and 8/9	Four pairs 5/6, 6/7, 7/8 and 8/9
6.	**Pharynx**	3rd – 4th segment	Runs up to 4th Segment
7.	**Oesophagus**	5th segment	8th segment
8.	**Gizzard**	6th segment	8th – 9th segment
9.	**Intestine**	7th segment to anus	15th segment to anus
10.	**Intestinal caeca**	Absent	Present in 26th segment
11.	**Lateral hearts**	8 pairs from 6th to 13th segments	3 pairs from 7th to 9th segments
12.	**Pharyngeal nephridia**	5th - 9th segment	4th – 6th segment
13.	**Micronephridia**	14th to last segment	7th to last segment
14.	**Meganephridia**	19th to last segment	15th to last segment
15.	**Male genital pore**	18th segment	18th segment
16.	**Female genital pore**	14th segment	14th segment

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